Brighter Days Collection

30+ Christmas Activities for Seniors

Simple, joyful ways to fill December with memory, laughter and connection.



Spark Memories

Bring Families Together

Easy to Print

A Plan for All of December

BEFORE YOU START

How to Use This Pack

This pack is built for December: one simple activity at a time, for a caregiver and one senior, or for a whole group.

FOR PAIRS OR FOR GROUPS

ONE-ON-ONE

Perfect for a caregiver and one senior at home. Slow down, talk, and enjoy each step together.

GROUP SETTING

Great for senior living communities. Gather a small group around a table and take turns.

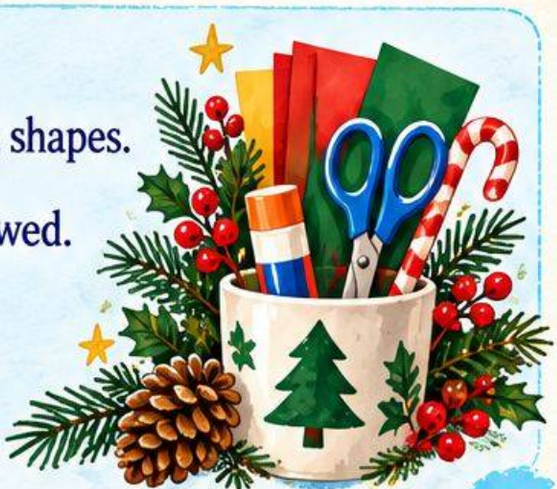
YOUR DAILY ROUTINE

1. Check today's date on **Your December Plan** (next page).
2. Pick the activity for today, or any one you like.
3. Spend 10 to 15 minutes together, no rush.



SAFETY FIRST

- Use only blunt, round-tip scissors, or pre-cut shapes.
- Avoid very small items that could be swallowed.
- Supervise closely during any craft activity.
- Battery candles only, never an open flame.



BEFORE YOU START

Your December Plan



One simple activity for every day of December.
Check the box once it's done!

☐ **1** Christmas Traditions



☐ **2** Paper Snowflakes



☐ **3** Christmas Bingo



☐ **4** Sing-Along Carols



☐ **5** Jingle Bell Arms & Feet



☐ **6** Letter to the Grandchildren



☐ **7** My Childhood Christmas



☐ **8** Handmade Cards



☐ **9** Christmas Trivia



☐ **10** Guess the Carol



☐ **11** Pass the Present



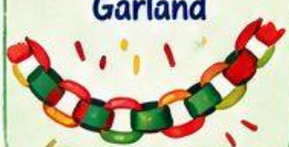
☐ **12** Family Recipe



☐ **13** The Scents of Christmas



☐ **14** Paper Garland



☐ **15** Memory Match



☐ **16** Jingle Bell Rhythm



☐ **17** Christmas Tree Stretch



☐ **18** Photo Frame to Color



☐ **19** The Christmas Memory Jar



☐ **20** Paint an Ornament



☐ **21** Christmas Word Search



☐ **22** Carol Circle



☐ **23** Seated Holiday Dance



☐ **24** Table Centerpiece



☐ **25** CHRISTMAS DAY — Celebrate with the Party Plan!



Bonus Days: An Unforgettable Gift · Gift Wrapping Together · Guess the Christmas Object · Christmas Foods We Loved · Classic Music Listening Session · Christmas Crossword

ACTIVITY 01

CHRISTMAS MEMORIES

TIME: 15 min | **FOR:** Pairs or Group | **GOAL:** Memory & Conversation

Christmas Traditions Through the Years



Every family has its own Christmas magic. Let's talk about yours.

WHAT YOU NEED



A quiet, comfy spot



A cup of hot cocoa (optional)

STEP BY STEP

1. **ASK** — "What did your family always do on Christmas Eve?"
2. **LISTEN** — Let the story unfold, no rush.
3. **COMPARE** — "What's different about Christmas today?"
4. **WRITE IT DOWN** — Jot down one favorite tradition to keep.

MAKE IT EASIER:



Show a Christmas photo to spark the memory.

MAKE IT HARDER:



Ask for a full story, start to finish.

CAREGIVER TIP

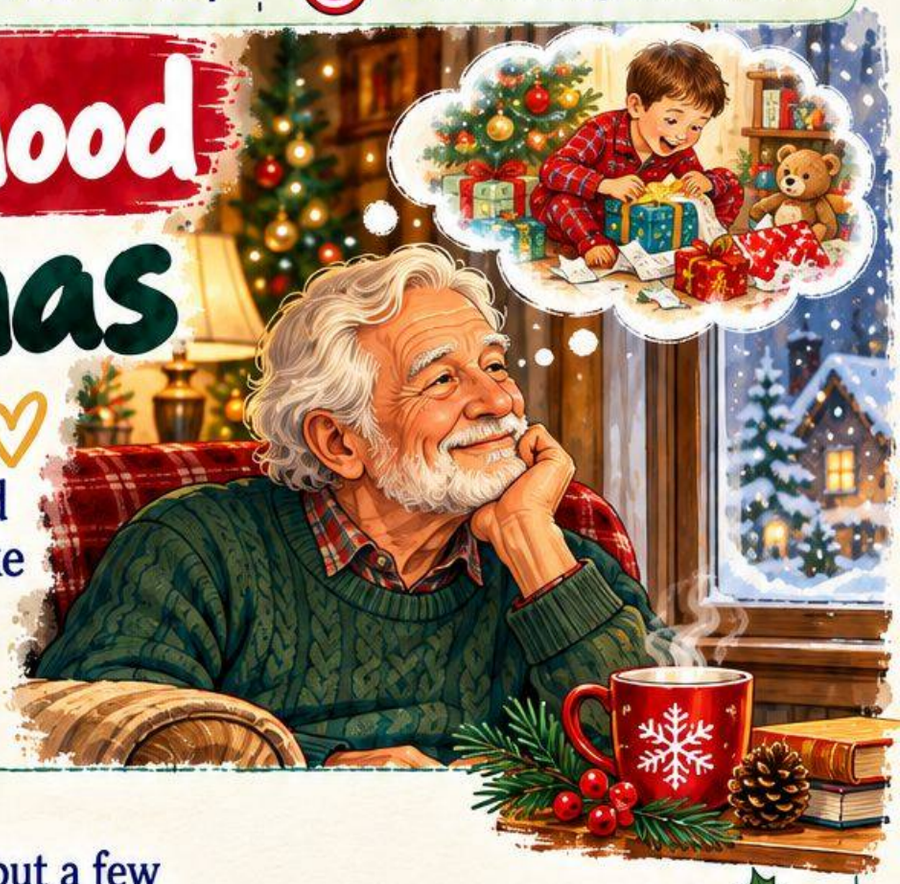
There are no wrong answers. If a memory brings tears, that's okay too — just listen.

ACTIVITY 02

CHRISTMAS MEMORIES

TIME: 10 min | **FOR:** Pairs or Group | **GOAL:** Memory & Reminiscence

My Childhood Christmas



Close your eyes. What did Christmas morning feel like when you were young?

WHAT YOU NEED



Nothing but a few quiet minutes

STEP BY STEP

1. **SETTLE IN** — Sit comfortably, take a slow breath.
2. **REMEMBER** — "What was your very first Christmas memory?"
3. **DESCRIBE** — The smells, the sounds, the people in the room.
4. **SHARE** — Tell it out loud, or write a few words.

MAKE IT EASIER:

Ask one simple question: "Were you naughty or nice?"

MAKE IT HARDER:

Ask them to describe the whole morning, minute by minute.

CAREGIVER TIP

Soft Christmas music playing in the background helps memories surface.

ACTIVITY 03

CHRISTMAS MEMORIES

TIME: 10 min | **FOR:** Pairs or Group | **GOAL:** Senses & Memory

The Scents of Christmas



Close your eyes and let your nose bring back the holidays.

WHAT YOU NEED



Cinnamon sticks



A small pine branch



Orange peel



Peppermint



A gingerbread cookie

STEP BY STEP

1. **PREPARE** — Put a little of each scent in its own small jar.
2. **SMELL** — One jar at a time, eyes closed.
3. **GUESS** — Name the scent.
4. **REMEMBER** — "Where have you smelled this before?"

MAKE IT EASIER:



Offer only 3 scents instead of 5.

MAKE IT HARDER:



Guess the scent with no hints at all.

CAREGIVER TIP

Avoid strong artificial fragrances and check of allergies first.

TIME: 15 min | **FOR:** Pairs or Group | **GOAL:** Memory & Storytelling

The Christmas Memory Jar



A jar full of little questions that unlock big holiday memories.

WHAT YOU NEED



A glass jar or box



Paper slips



A pen

STEP BY STEP

1. **FILL THE JAR** — Write 10 Christmas questions on slips of paper and fold them in.
2. **PICK ONE** — Draw a slip and read it aloud.
3. **SHARE** — Answer with as much detail as you like.
4. **KEEP GOING** — Draw another whenever you're ready.

SAMPLE QUESTIONS

- What was your favorite Christmas gift ever?
- Who cooked the Christmas dinner in your family?
- What Christmas song always makes you smile?
- Did you ever have a Christmas surprise?
- What's one Christmas you'll never forget?

MAKE IT EASIER:



Read the questions for them.

MAKE IT HARDER:



Ask a follow-up question for every answer.

CAREGIVER TIP

Keep the jar out all December. It becomes a favorite daily ritual.

ACTIVITY 05

CHRISTMAS MEMORIES

TIME: 10 min | **FOR:** Pairs or Group | **GOAL:** Memory & Emotion

An Unforgettable Gift



Some gifts we never forget.
Let's remember yours.

WHAT YOU NEED

Just your memory and a listening ear

STEP BY STEP

1. **ASK** — "What's the best gift you ever received?"
2. **ASK MORE** — "What's the best gift you ever gave?"
3. **DESCRIBE** — Who gave it, and how did it feel to open it?
4. **CELEBRATE** — Share a smile or a laugh about it.

MAKE IT EASIER:



Show pictures of common gifts (a bicycle, a doll, a watch) to spark ideas.

MAKE IT HARDER:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ask them to rank their top 3 gifts of all time.

CAREGIVER TIP

Homemade or handmade gifts often bring out the most touching stories.

TIME: 15 min | **FOR:** Pairs or Group | **GOAL:** Memory & Connection

Christmas Foods We Loved



What did your holiday table look like, and taste like?

WHAT YOU NEED



A sample taste of one holiday food, if possible (optional)



STEP BY STEP

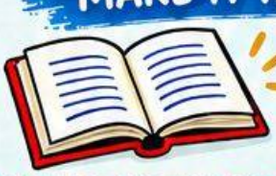
1. **ASK** — "What dish could you never skip at Christmas?"
2. **ASK** — "Who made it, and how?"
3. **TASTE** — If possible, try a small bite of something similar.
4. **WRITE IT DOWN** — Save the recipe name for the family recipe card later in this book.

MAKE IT EASIER:



Offer a list to choose from: turkey, ham, pie, cookies.

MAKE IT HARDER:



Ask them to describe the full recipe from memory.

CAREGIVER TIP

This pairs beautifully with Activity 29, Write the Family Recipe Together.

TIME: 15 min | **FOR:** Pairs or Group | **GOAL:** Coordination & Creativity

Paper Snowflake Ornaments



Fold, snip and unfold: a little bit of winter magic in your hands.

WHAT YOU NEED



Square paper (white or light blue)



Blunt-tip scissors

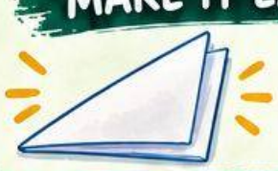


Thread, for hanging

STEP BY STEP

1. **FOLD** — Fold the paper in half, then in half again, then into a triangle.
2. **SNIP** — Cut small shapes along the folded edges.
3. **UNFOLD** — Carefully open the paper to reveal the snowflake.
4. **HANG** — Tie a thread and hang it in a window.

MAKE IT EASIER:



Use pre-folded paper, just snip the edges.

MAKE IT HARDER:



Try a more detailed snowflake with extra folds.

CAREGIVER TIP

Always use blunt, round-tip scissors and stay close to help with the folding.

TIME: 15 min | **FOR:** Pairs or Group | **GOAL:** Creativity & Connection

Handmade Christmas Cards



A card made by hand means more than any card from a store.

WHAT YOU NEED



Folded cardstock



Markers and stickers



Envelopes

STEP BY STEP

1. **FOLD** — A sheet of cardstock in half.
2. **DECORATE** — Stickers, stamps or a simple drawing.
3. **WRITE** — A short warm message inside.
4. **SEND** — Mail it or hand-deliver it with a hug.

MAKE IT EASIER:



Use pre-printed cards, just add a signature.

MAKE IT HARDER:



Write a short poem or holiday wish inside.

CAREGIVER TIP

Make a small stack ready for family, friends, and the mail carrier too.

TIME: 15 min | **FOR:** Pairs or Group | **GOAL:** Coordination & Creativity

Simple Paper Garland



Loop by loop, a colorful chain grows long enough for the whole room.

WHAT YOU NEED



Strips of red and green paper



A glue stick

STEP BY STEP

1. **LOOP** — Glue the ends of one strip into a circle.
2. **LINK** — Thread the next strip through the loop before gluing it closed.
3. **REPEAT** — Keep linking loops to grow the chain.
4. **HANG** — Drape it along a manfel, doorway or tree.

MAKE IT EASIER:



Pre-cut strips, just glue and link.

MAKE IT HARDER:



Alternate colors in a pattern (red, green, gold).

CAREGIVER TIP

A glue stick is much easier to manage than liquid glue or tape.

TIME: 15 min | **FOR:** Pairs or Group | **GOAL:** Creativity & Focus

Paint an Ornament



One plain ornament becomes a one-of-a-kind keepsake.

WHAT YOU NEED



A plain wooden or plastic ornament



Acrylic paint



A brush



Newspaper to protect the table

STEP BY STEP

1. **PROTECT THE TABLE** — Lay down newspaper.
2. **PAINT** — Dots, stripes or a simple design.
3. **DRY** — Let it sit untouched for an hour.
4. **HANG** — Add it to the tree with pride.

MAKE IT EASIER:



Use paint pens instead of a brush for more control.

MAKE IT HARDER:



Paint a small scene or a name on the ornament.

CAREGIVER TIP

Plastic ornaments are safer than glass for shaky hands.

TIME: 15 min | **FOR:** Pairs | **GOAL:** Coordination & Purpose

Gift Wrapping Together



Wrapping a gift together makes the giving twice as special.

WHAT YOU NEED



Small gift boxes



Wrapping paper



Ribbon



Gift tags

STEP BY STEP

1. **WRAP** — Fold the paper around the box together.
2. **TIE** — Wrap a ribbon and tie a simple bow.
3. **WRITE** — Fill out a gift tag by hand.
4. **STACK** — Place it under the tree.

MAKE IT EASIER:



Use gift bags instead of wrapping paper.

MAKE IT HARDER:



Add a hand-folded bow made of ribbon.

CAREGIVER TIP

Let them tie the bow, even if it's a little uneven. It's the thought that counts.

TIME: 15 min | **FOR:** Pairs or Group | **GOAL:** Creativity & Pride

Christmas Centerpiece



A beautiful centerpiece for the table, made with your own hands.

WHAT YOU NEED



A round tray or plate



Pinecones and holly sprigs



Small ornaments



A battery-operated candle

STEP BY STEP

1. **BASE** — Start with the tray.
2. **ARRANGE** — Pinecones and holly around the edge.
3. **ADD COLOR** — Tuck in a few small ornaments.
4. **FINISH** — Place the battery candle in the center.

MAKE IT EASIER:



Use a simpler arrangement with fewer pieces.

MAKE IT HARDER:



Add a second layer with ribbon woven through.

CAREGIVER TIP

Always use a battery candle. Never an open flame around dry pine.

TIME: 15 min | **FOR:** Group | **GOAL:** Social & Attention

Christmas Bingo



Big pictures, big smiles, and a little friendly competition.

WHAT YOU NEED



Printable bingo cards (pages 36–37 of this book)



Chips, buttons or dry beans as markers

STEP BY STEP

1. **HAND OUT CARDS** – One per player, from the printable pages.
2. **CALL** – Say each item slowly, twice.
3. **MARK** – Players cover it if they have it.
4. **BINGO!** – First to complete a row calls out "Bingo!"

MAKE IT EASIER:



Play until anyone gets 3 in a row.

MAKE IT HARDER:



Play a full card blackout.

CAREGIVER TIP

Let a player call the items once in a while. They love being in charge.

TIME: 10 min | **FOR:** Pairs or Group | **GOAL:** Memory & Trivia

Christmas Trivia



How much do you know about the holidays? Circle your answer.

1	What color is traditionally paired with red at Christmas?	A Green	B Purple	C Orange
2	On what date is Christmas Eve?	A December 24	B December 31	C December 1
3	What do people traditionally kiss under?	A Mistletoe	B Holly	C A poinsettia
4	What pulls Santa's sleigh?	A Reindeer	B Horses	C Dogs
5	What is traditionally left out for Santa?	A Milk and cookies	B Coffee and cake	C Juice and bread
6	What goes on top of the Christmas tree?	A A star or an angel	B A bell	C A candy cane
7	Where is Santa's home said to be?	A The North Pole	B The South Pole	C Christmas Island
8	What do carolers often ring while singing?	A Bells	B Drums	C Trumpets

ANSWERS: 1A · 2A · 3A · 4A · 5B · 6A · 7A · 8A

TIME: 15 min | **FOR:** Pairs or Group | **GOAL:** Memory & Focus

Christmas Memory Match



Flip two at a time and find the matching holiday pairs.

Candy Cane	Ornament	Bell	Holly
Snowflake	Stocking	Candy Cane	Ornament
Bell	Holly	Snowflake	Stocking

WHAT YOU NEED

- Scissors to cut the cards
- A flat table

MAKE IT EASIER:

Lay out only 8 cards (4 pairs).

MAKE IT HARDER:

Use all 12 cards and play against the clock.

STEP BY STEP

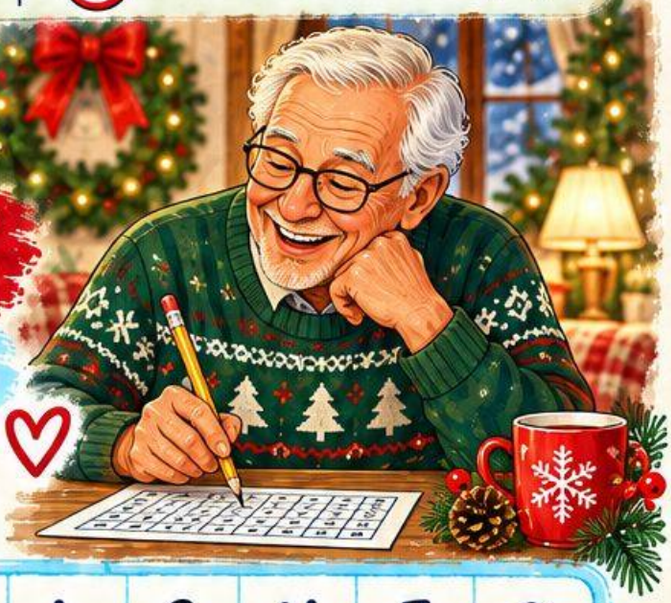
1. **CUT** — Along the dashed lines.
2. **SHUFFLE** — Mix all 12 cards face down.
3. **FLIP** — Two cards at a time.
4. **MATCH** — Keep pairs, flip back non-matches.

CAREGIVER TIP

Glue the cards onto thin cardboard first so they last for many Christmases.

TIME: 10 min | **FOR:** Pairs or Group | **GOAL:** Attention & Language

Large-Print Christmas Word Search



Find the 10 words. They go across or down.

B	U	R	I	B	E	L	L	S	N	F	O
N	F	A	I	W	R	I	A	N	G	E	L
W	S	L	E	I	G	H	R	M	W	Y	F
R	C	M	U	I	B	Y	P	G	I	F	T
E	C	E	O	I	S	N	N	U	S	B	W
A	A	K	P	S	C	A	V	D	A	O	P
T	R	R	C	N	A	B	R	D	N	A	W
H	O	U	M	O	N	C	B	S	T	Y	P
L	L	E	N	W	D	T	N	D	A	S	R
L	B	M	L	C	L	C	S	W	G	W	P
C	R	K	Y	G	E	D	R	A	L	E	G
S	Y	V	H	I	R	S	T	A	R	S	M

FIND THESE WORDS:

SANTA • STAR • ANGEL • CANDLE • WREATH • SLEIGH • CAROL • GIFT • SNOW • BELLS

TIME: 10 min | **FOR:** Pairs or Group | **GOAL:** Attention & Guessing

Guess the Christmas Object

Feel it, describe it, guess it!
No peeking.



WHAT YOU NEED



A cloth bag



8 small Christmas objects (a bell, a pinecone, a candy cane, an ornament, a mitten, a small bow, a jingle bell, a wrapped soap bar as a 'present')

STEP BY STEP

1. **FILL THE BAG** — With the 8 objects, out of sight.
2. **REACH IN** — Pick one object without looking.
3. **DESCRIBE** — "It's small, round and smooth..."
4. **GUESS** — Name the object, then pull it out to check!

MAKE IT EASIER:

Let them look at the objects first, then guess by touch.

MAKE IT HARDER:

No hints at all, touch only.

CAREGIVER TIP

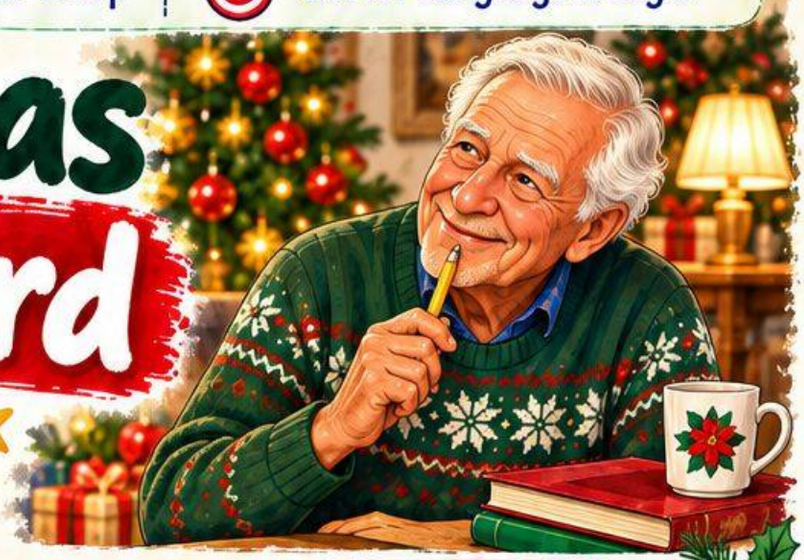
Choose smooth, safe objects — nothing sharp or small enough to swallow.

ACTIVITY 18

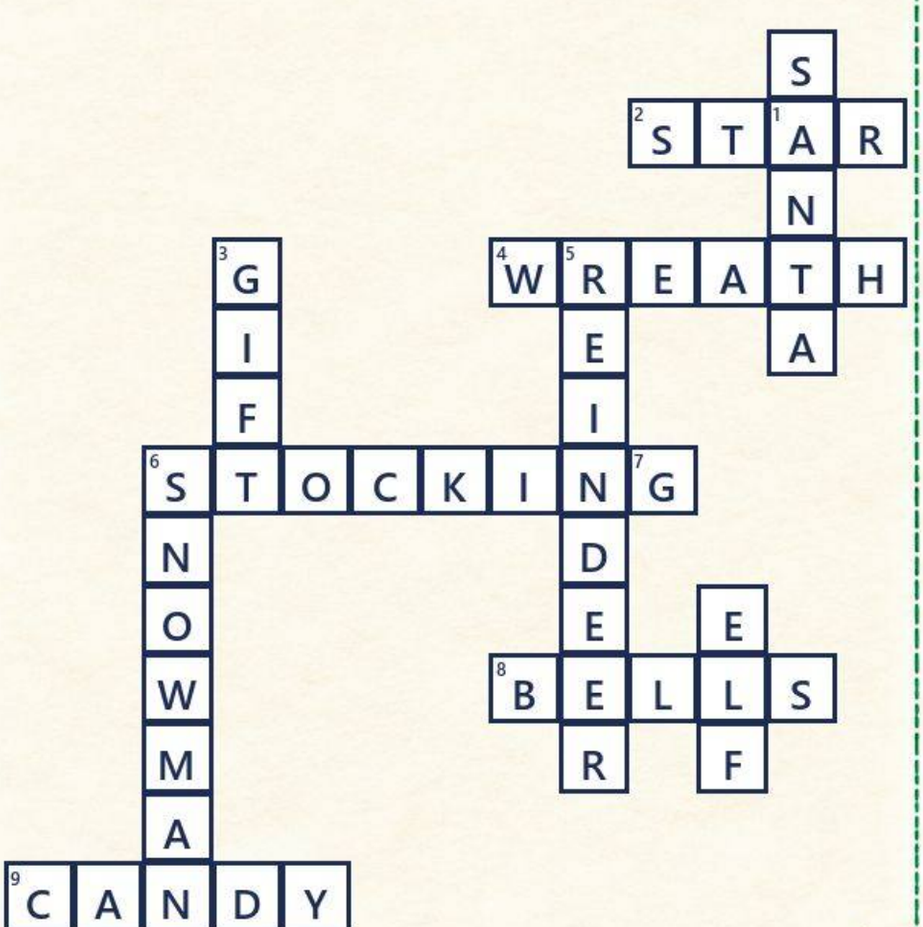
CHRISTMAS GAMES

TIME: 15 min | **FOR:** Pairs or Group | **GOAL:** Language & Logic

Christmas Crossword



Use the clues to fill in the Christmas crossword.



ACROSS

2. It shines at the top of the Christmas tree.
4. A circle of pine you hang on the door.
6. Hung by the chimney with care.
8. They jingle all the way.
9. A sweet treat, often shaped like a cane.

DOWN

1. He wears a red suit and slides down the chimney.
3. You wrap it and put a bow on it.
5. Santa's sleigh is pulled by these.
6. Built from three snowballs, with a carrot nose.
7. Santa's little helper in the workshop.

ANSWERS: Across: 2 star · 4 wreath · 6 stocking · 8 bells · 9 candy — Down: 1 santa · 3 gift · 5 reindeer · 6 snowman · 7 elf

Down: 1 santa · 3 gift · 5 reindeer · 6 snowman · 7 elf

TIME: 15 min | **FOR:** Pairs or Group | **GOAL:** Mood & Connection

Christmas Carol Sing-Along



There's no better way to feel the season than singing together.

WHAT YOU NEED



Large-print lyric sheets (pages 38–39 of this book)

STEP BY STEP

1. **PICK A CAROL** — Start with a favorite.
2. **HAND OUT LYRICS** — One sheet per person, or share.
3. **SING** — Slowly, together, no pressure to hit every note.
4. **REPEAT** — Sing a few carols in a row for a full sing-along.

MAKE IT EASIER:

Just hum along if the words are hard to read.

MAKE IT HARDER:



Try singing a round, with different people starting at different times.

CAREGIVER TIP

Music memory often stays strong even when other memories fade. This is one of the most powerful activities in the whole book.

ACTIVITY 20

MUSIC & CAROLS

TIME: 10 min | **FOR:** Pairs or Group | **GOAL:** Memory & Fun

Guess the Carol



Hum the tune, no words allowed.
Can they guess the carol?

WHAT YOU NEED



A list of carols everyone knows (Jingle Bells, Silent Night, Deck the Halls, Joy to the World, We Wish You a Merry Christmas)

STEP BY STEP

1. **PICK A CAROL** — Keep it secret.
2. **HUM** — The tune only, no words.
3. **GUESS** — Let them guess the title.
4. **SWITCH** — Take turns humming and guessing.

MAKE IT EASIER:

Hum with a few words mixed in as a hint.

MAKE IT HARDER:



Hum just the first 3 notes.

CAREGIVER TIP

Celebrate every guess, right or wrong.
The fun is in the trying.

ACTIVITY 21

MUSIC & CAROLS

TIME: 10 min | **FOR:** Pairs or Group | **GOAL:** Movement & Rhythm

Jingle Bell Rhythm

Shake, jingle, smile!
A merry way to move the arms.



WHAT YOU NEED

Jingle bells, bell bracelets, or small bells on a ribbon



STEP BY STEP

1. **HAND OUT BELLS** — One set per person.
2. **PLAY MUSIC** — A favorite carol.
3. **SHAKE** — To the beat, fast or slow.
4. **TAKE TURNS** — Each person leads a rhythm for the others to copy.

MAKE IT EASIER:

Just shake along freely, no set rhythm.

MAKE IT HARDER:

Try a call-and-response rhythm pattern.

CAREGIVER TIP

This is a wonderful warm-up before Activity 19, the sing-along.

ACTIVITY 22

MUSIC & CAROLS

TIME: 15 min | **FOR:** Group | **GOAL:** Social & Rhythm

Carol Circle



Pass the bell, sing along, and feel the whole room come together.

WHAT YOU NEED



One large jingle bell or small bell



Chairs set in a circle

STEP BY STEP

1. **SIT IN A CIRCLE** — Close enough to pass the bell by hand.
2. **SING** — Start a favorite carol together.
3. **PASS** — The bell moves around the circle with the beat.
4. **KEEP GOING** — Sing a few carols, passing the bell each time.

MAKE IT EASIER:



Pass the bell slowly, without matching the beat exactly.

MAKE IT HARDER:



Pass faster as the song speeds up.

CAREGIVER TIP

A big circle works best so everyone can see and hear each other.

ACTIVITY 23

MUSIC & CAROLS

TIME: 15 min | **FOR:** Pairs or Group | **GOAL:** Memory & Mood

Classic Christmas Listening Session



Sit back, close your eyes, and let the classics carry you away.

WHAT YOU NEED



A playlist of classic instrumental Christmas music



A comfortable chair

STEP BY STEP

1. **GET COMFORTABLE** — Dim the lights a little.
2. **PLAY THE MUSIC** — Soft, classic holiday instrumentals.
3. **LISTEN** — Eyes closed, just breathing and listening.
4. **TALK** — Afterward, share what memories came up.

MAKE IT EASIER:

Keep it short, just one or two songs.

MAKE IT HARDER:

Ask them to name the song or hum along.

CAREGIVER TIP

This is a gentle, calming activity — wonderful in the evening.

ACTIVITY 24

SEATED HOLIDAY MOVEMENT

TIME: 10 min | **FOR:** Pairs or Group | **GOAL:** Movement & Joy

Jingle Bell Arms & Feet

Shake those bells!
A merry seated workout
to your favorite carol.



WHAT YOU NEED



Bell bracelets for wrists and ankles



A sturdy chair

STEP BY STEP

1. **PUT ON THE BELLS** — Wrists and ankles.
2. **PLAY "JINGLE BELLS"** — Or any upbeat carol.
3. **MOVE** — Lift the arms, tap the feet, shake to the beat.
4. **REST** — Slow down as the song ends.

MAKE IT EASIER:



Move just the arms, seated and relaxed.

MAKE IT HARDER:



Add small claps between movements.

CAREGIVER TIP

Keep movements small and controlled — the joy is in the jingle, not the speed.

ACTIVITY 25

SEATED HOLIDAY MOVEMENT

TIME: 10 min | **FOR:** Group | **GOAL:** Movement & Social

Pass the Present



Pass it quick before the music stops! A merry game for the whole circle.

WHAT YOU NEED



A wrapped empty gift box



Music to play and pause

STEP BY STEP

1. **SIT IN A CIRCLE** — Close enough to pass easily.
2. **START THE MUSIC** — Pass the box around the circle.
3. **MUSIC STOPS** — Whoever holds it answers a fun question or shares a memory.
4. **KEEP PLAYING** — Everyone gets a turn, no one is "out."

MAKE IT EASIER:



Pass it slowly and give everyone plenty of time.

MAKE IT HARDER:



Add a second box moving the opposite direction.

CAREGIVER TIP

Keep the questions light and fun, like "What's your favorite Christmas color?"

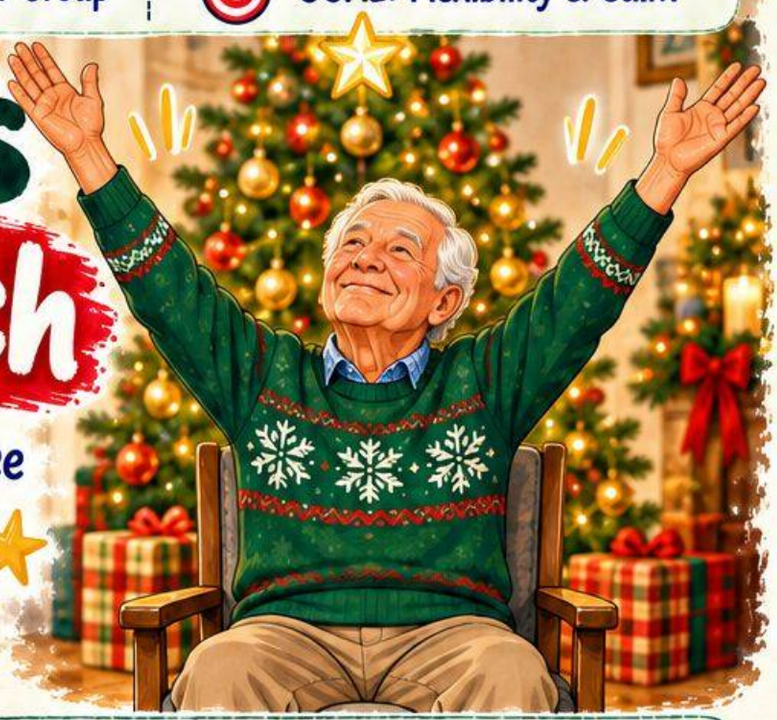
ACTIVITY 26

SEATED HOLIDAY MOVEMENT

TIME: 10 min | **FOR:** Pairs or Group | **GOAL:** Flexibility & Calm

Christmas Tree Stretch

Reach up like a Christmas tree reaching for the stars.



WHAT YOU NEED



A sturdy chair



Comfortable clothing

STEP BY STEP

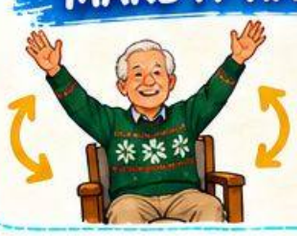
1. **SIT TALL** — Feet flat on the floor.
2. **BRANCHES UP** — Slowly raise both arms up and out to the sides.
3. **HOLD** — Breathe gently for 3 seconds, like the tree standing still.
4. **LOWER** — Bring the arms down slowly, like branches settling.

MAKE IT EASIER:



Raise one arm at a time.

MAKE IT HARDER:



Add a gentle side-to-side sway, like branches in the wind.

CAREGIVER TIP

Move slowly and stop if there's any shoulder discomfort.

TIME: 15 min | **FOR:** Pairs or Group | **GOAL:** Mood & Movement

Seated Holiday Dance



You don't need to stand up to dance – just move to the music, your way.

WHAT YOU NEED



A playlist of upbeat Christmas songs.

STEP BY STEP

1. **GET COMFORTABLE** — Seated, with space to move the arms.
2. **PLAY A SONG** — Something upbeat and familiar.
3. **MOVE** — Sway, clap, tap your feet, raise your arms.
4. **SMILE** — Let the music carry you, there's no wrong way to dance.

MAKE IT EASIER:



Just clap along to the beat.

MAKE IT HARDER:

Follow a simple sequence: clap, sway, raise arms, repeat.

CAREGIVER TIP

Join in! Dancing together is more fun, and more encouraging, than watching.

ACTIVITY 28

FAMILY CONNECTION

TIME: 15 min | FOR: Pairs | GOAL: Family & Legacy

Letter to the Grandchildren



Your words, your wisdom, saved for the ones who will treasure them most.

Dear _____,

_____

_____

_____

This Christmas, I want you to know...

_____

_____

My favorite Christmas memory with you is...

_____

_____

I hope you always remember...

_____

_____

With love, _____

WHAT YOU NEED



Nice paper



A pen

STEP BY STEP

1. **SETTLE IN** — Somewhere cozy and quiet.
2. **DICTATE OR WRITE** — Share your thoughts, one line at a time.
3. **SIGN** — With your name or a nickname they'll recognize.
4. **DELIVER** — Mail it, or save it for Christmas morning.

MAKE IT EASIER:



If writing is hard, they speak and you write.

MAKE IT HARDER:



Write a separate letter for each grandchild.

CAREGIVER TIP

These letters often become treasured keepsakes for generations.

ACTIVITY 29

FAMILY CONNECTION

TIME: 20 min | FOR: Pairs | GOAL: Memory & Legacy

Write the Family Recipe Together



Every family has a Christmas dish that must never be forgotten.

Recipe name: _____

Ingredients: _____

_____

_____

_____

Steps: _____

_____

_____

_____

A memory about this dish: _____

_____

_____

_____

WHAT YOU NEED



A recipe card or notebook



A pen

STEP BY STEP

1. **PICK A DISH** — The one that always appears at Christmas.
2. **DICTATE** — Ingredients first, then the steps.
3. **ADD A STORY** — Who taught you this recipe?
4. **SAVE IT** — Keep the card with the family recipe box.

MAKE IT EASIER:



Just list the ingredients, skip exact measurements.

MAKE IT HARDER:



Write out the full step-by-step method.

CAREGIVER TIP

Bake it together next, and bring a slice to share with the whole family.

ACTIVITY 30

FAMILY CONNECTION

TIME: 15 min | FOR: Pairs or Group | GOAL: Creativity & Family

Color the Christmas Photo Frame

Color a frame fit for your favorite holiday photo.



Place your photo here.

WHAT YOU NEED



Colored pencils or markers



A favorite family Christmas photo



Tape or glue

STEP BY STEP

1. **COLOR** — Fill in the holly, berries and bow.
2. **CHOOSE A PHOTO** — A favorite from this Christmas or years past.
3. **ATTACH** — Tape or glue the photo in the center.
4. **DISPLAY** — Hang it or prop it up to enjoy all season.

MAKE IT EASIER:



Color just a few sections, leave the rest white.

MAKE IT HARDER:



Add extra details, like little bells on the bow.

CAREGIVER TIP

A great way to display a precious new photo, or an old favorite.

YOUR CHRISTMAS PARTY · PART 1

Your 60-Minute Christmas Party



SCHEDULE

1. **0–5 min:** Welcome & Seating — greet everyone, soft carols playing
2. **5–15 min:** Opening Sing-Along (Activity 19)
3. **15–30 min:** Christmas Bingo (Activity 13)
4. **30–40 min:** Pass the Present (Activity 25)
5. **40–50 min:** Snack Time & Conversation
6. **50–60 min:** Closing Carol & Group Photo

SIMPLE DECORATION IDEAS



String lights around the room



A small tree as the centerpiece



Red and green tablecloth



Name cards at each seat

YOUR CHRISTMAS PARTY · PART 2

Games, Songs & Snacks



3 PARTY GAMES



Christmas Bingo
(Activity 13)



Christmas Trivia
(Activity 14)



Guess the Carol
(Activity 20)

SING-ALONG SONG LIST



- Jingle Bells
- Deck the Halls
- We Wish You a Merry Christmas
- O Christmas Tree
- Joy to the World



EASY-TO-CHEW SNACK IDEAS



Soft sugar cookies



Warm hot cocoa



Mashed banana "eggnog" smoothie



Soft dinner rolls with butter



Pudding cups with a sprinkle of cinnamon

Merry Christmas! Thank you for bringing joy to every day of December.

Christmas Bingo Cards

B	I	N	G	O
Fireplace	Santa Claus	Bell	Gingerbread Man	Stocking
Star	Hot Cocoa	Poinsettia	Angel	Candy Cane
Snowman	Elf	FREE	Reindeer	Nutcracker
Wreath	Holly	Sleigh	Pine Cone	Present
Snowflake	Ornament	Christmas Tree	Christmas Lights	Mistletoe

B	I	N	G	O
Elf	Star	Pine Cone	Bell	Poinsettia
Christmas Lights	Wreath	Angel	Sleigh	Stocking
Santa Claus	Gingerbread Man	FREE	Christmas Tree	Nutcracker
Snowflake	Mistletoe	Hot Cocoa	Fireplace	Present
Reindeer	Ornament	Snowman	Holly	Candy Cane

Jingle Bells

Jingle bells, jingle bells,
jingle all the way!
Oh what fun it is to ride
in a one-horse open
sleigh, hey!
Jingle bells, jingle bells,
jingle all the way!
Oh what fun it is to ride
in a one-horse open
sleigh!

Deck the Halls

Deck the halls with boughs
of holly, Fa la la la la, la la la la.
'Tis the season to be jolly,
Fa la la la la, la la la la.
Don we now our gay apparel,
Fa la la, la la la, la la la.
Troll the ancient Yuletide carol,
Fa la la la la, la la la la.

We Wish You a Merry Christmas

We wish you a merry
Christmas, we wish you a
merry Christmas,
we wish you a merry
Christmas and a happy
New Year.
Good tidings we bring to you
and your kin;
good tidings for Christmas
and a happy New Year.

O Christmas Tree

O Christmas tree,
O Christmas tree,
how lovely are your branches!
O Christmas tree,
O Christmas tree,
how lovely are your branches!
In summer sun or winter snow,
a coat of green you always show.
O Christmas tree,
O Christmas tree,
how lovely are your branches!

GAME ANSWER KEY

All Your Answers in One Place

Every game in this book also has its own answer strip, printed upside down right on the page. Here they are again, all together.

1 ACTIVITY 16 — Large-Print Christmas Word Search

SANTA · STAR · ANGEL · CANDLE · WREATH · SLEIGH · CAROL · GIFT · SNOW · BELLS — all 10 words are hidden across or down in the grid.

2 ACTIVITY 18 — Christmas Crossword

Across: 2 star · 4 wreath · 6 stocking · 8 bells · 9 candy —
Down: 1 santa · 3 gift · 5 reindeer · 6 snowman · 7 elf

3 ACTIVITY 14 — Christmas Trivia

1A · 2A · 3A · 4A · 5A · 6A · 7A · 8A

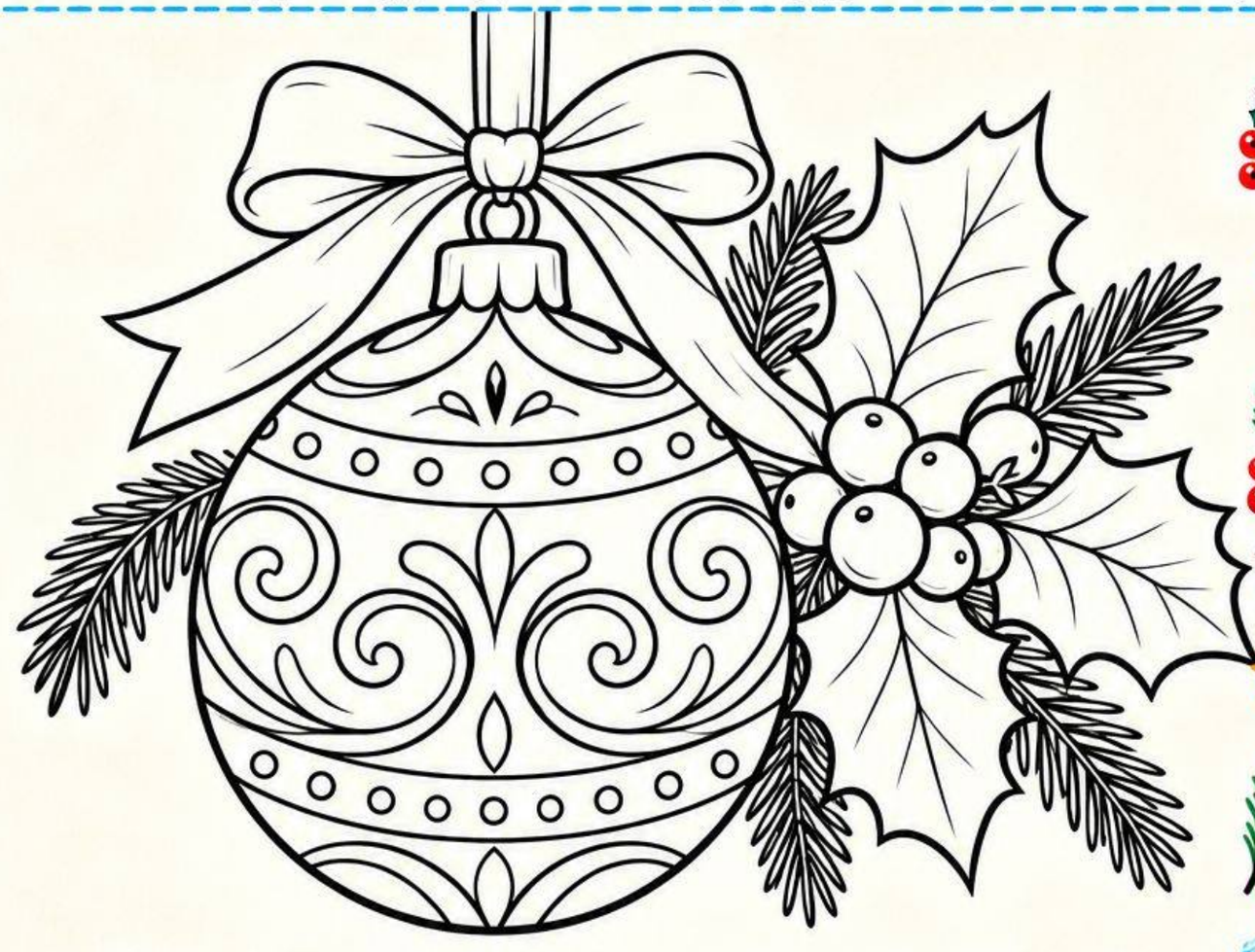


Wishing you and your loved ones a season full of brighter days.









Paper Ornaments to Cut and Hang

Cut along the dashed lines with blunt scissors, punch a small hole, and hang with thread or ribbon.













Jingle Bells

Jingle bells, jingle bells,
jingle all the way!
Oh what fun it is to ride
in a one-horse open
sleigh, hey!
Jingle bells, jingle bells,
jingle all the way!
Oh what fun it is to ride
in a one-horse open
sleigh!

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Deck the halls with boughs
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Don we now our gay apparel,
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We Wish You a Merry Christmas

We wish you a merry
Christmas, we wish you a
merry Christmas,
we wish you a merry
Christmas and a happy
New Year.
Good tidings we bring to you
and your kin;
good tidings for Christmas
and a happy New Year.

O Christmas Tree

O Christmas tree,
O Christmas tree,
how lovely are your branches!
O Christmas tree,
O Christmas tree,
how lovely are your branches!
In summer sun or winter snow,
a coat of green you always show.
O Christmas tree,
O Christmas tree,
how lovely are your branches!

Joy to the World

Joy to the world, the Lord is come!
Let earth receive her King;
Let every heart prepare Him room,
And heaven and nature sing,
And heaven and nature sing,
And heaven, and heaven,
and nature sing.

Silent Night



Silent night, holy night,
All is calm, all is bright,
Round yon virgin mother and child.
Holy infant so tender and mild,
Sleep in heavenly peace,
Sleep in heavenly peace.

Hark! The Herald Angels Sing



Hark! The herald angels sing,
'Glory to the newborn King;
Peace on earth, and mercy mild,
God and sinners reconciled!'
Joyful, all ye nations, rise,
Join the triumph of the skies;
With the angelic host proclaim,
'Christ is born in Bethlehem!'
Hark! The herald angels sing,
'Glory to the newborn King!'

O Come, All Ye Faithful



O come, all ye faithful,
joyful and triumphant,
O come ye, O come ye to Bethlehem;
Come and behold Him,
born the King of angels;
O come, let us adore Him,
O come, let us adore Him,
O come, let us adore Him,
Christ the Lord.

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